SANKALAN '26 · ALUMNI OUTREACH

Volunteer Call Script

A practical guide for following up on the alumni invitation email.
Read once, internalize the flow, then make the calls.

Corporate Communications Committee · PGDM-BM 38 · MDI Gurgaon

00 — MINDSET

Why this call matters

An email gets ignored. A phone call gets remembered. Even a 90-second conversation moves alumni from "I'll think about it" to "Yes, I'll be there."

You are not selling anything. You are extending a personal invitation from the current batch to someone who walked these same corridors years ago. Carry that warmth in your voice — and respect their time.

01 — BEFORE YOU DIAL

Pre-call preparation

60 seconds of prep per alum. Don't skip these.

- ☐ **Open their LinkedIn profile.** Note their current role, company, and any recent post or career update.
- ☐ **Note their batch / graduation year.** Recent alums get a peer-to-peer warmth; senior alums need more formality.
- ☐ **Pronounce their name correctly.** If unsure, check LinkedIn for audio name pronunciation or ask a teammate.
- ☐ **Confirm the email was sent** to that alum (check the tracker).
- ☐ **Keep handy:** the event schedule, RSVP tracker open, a pen for notes, the alumni list.
- ☐ **Best calling window:** weekday evenings 6:00–8:30 PM, or Saturday afternoons. Avoid Monday mornings and Friday evenings.

02 — FIRST 30 SECONDS

The opening

Identify yourself fast, signal it's an MDI call, and check if they have a moment to talk.

> YOU SAY
>
> *"Good evening, am I speaking with **Mr./Ms. [Surname]**? This is **[your name]** calling from MDI Gurgaon, on behalf of the Corporate Communications Committee of the PGDM-BM batch of 2026. I hope I've caught you at a good time?"*

Pause for their response. If they say yes, continue. If no, jump to the "Bad time" branch in Section 06.

03 — BRIDGE TO THE EMAIL

Reference the email

> YOU SAY
>
> *"Thank you, sir/ma'am. You should have received an email from us a few days back regarding **Sankalan '26** — the flagship business colloquium of our batch. I'm calling as a quick follow-up to that, just to share the details directly and check if we may have the honour of hosting you."*

If they say "I haven't seen it" — that's fine, the script continues normally. You'll offer to resend at the end.

04 — THE 45-SECOND PITCH

What you tell them about the event

Cover four things: date, panel theme, day flow, evening soirée. Keep it under 45 seconds.

> YOU SAY
>
> *"Sankalan '26 is happening on **Saturday, 20th June**, at MDI Gurgaon. We have an exceptional panel this year — senior leaders from Reliance, BCG, Flipkart, Genpact, Modi Enterprises, Saxo, and Business Octane Solutions — discussing **'Zero-Based Strategy: Redesigning Corporate Roadmaps When Resources Shrink.'***
>
> *The day begins with the inauguration at 9:30 AM, the panel discussion runs from 12 to 2 PM with open Q&A, followed by lunch, our CaseQuest student case competition, and concludes in the evening with a **networking soirée from 7 to 10 PM** — where we host alumni, panelists, and the batch together over dinner and music."*

05 — THE RSVP

The ask

Don't ask "would you like to come?" Ask "may I confirm you?" The framing matters.

> YOU SAY
>
> *"It would be our genuine honour to have you back on campus, sir/ma'am. The networking soirée especially is a wonderful chance to reconnect with the institution and meet old friends from the BM family. **May I go ahead and RSVP you as confirmed?**"*

Now stay silent. Let them respond. Silence here is your most powerful tool — resist the urge to keep talking.

06 — RESPONSE BRANCHES

What to say based on their response

Five possible responses. Every call ends in one of these branches.

IF THEY SAY YES

"Wonderful, sir/ma'am — thank you so much. I'll mark you as confirmed right away. You'll receive a final reminder a few days before the event with the schedule, parking details, and entry instructions. We're truly looking forward to welcoming you back to campus."

ACTION: *Log: Confirmed. Ask about dietary preferences, +1 (spouse/partner), accessibility needs. Mention WhatsApp group for confirmed alumni if applicable.*

IF THEY SAY MAYBE / I'LL CHECK

"Of course, sir/ma'am, I completely understand. May I follow up with you in two or three days? If it helps, the email already has the full schedule and a PDF attachment for your reference. Could I confirm the best email or phone to reach you on for the follow-up?"

ACTION: *Log: Pending callback. Set a specific callback date. Note preferred channel. Resend email if they confirm they haven't seen it.*

IF THEY SAY NO / CAN'T ATTEND

"I completely understand, sir/ma'am. Thank you so much for taking my call regardless — it means a lot to us. We'd love to keep you on our list for future events, and I'll make sure you receive an invite to those as well. Wishing you a wonderful evening."

ACTION: *Log: Declined. Briefly note the reason if they offer one. Do not push or counter-offer.*

IF IT'S A BAD TIME TO TALK

"My apologies for catching you at a busy moment, sir/ma'am. When would be a more convenient time for me to call back? I'll keep it brief — under two minutes."

ACTION: *Log: Callback scheduled. Note the exact time/day they suggest. Call back exactly when they said.*

IF YOU REACH VOICEMAIL OR THEY DON'T PICK UP

"Hello sir/ma'am, this is [your name] from MDI Gurgaon's Corporate Communications Committee.

> *I’m calling regarding Sankalan ’26 on the 20th of June — I had shared an email with you earlier. Would love to speak with you briefly when you have a moment. You can reach me back on this number, or simply reply to the email. Thank you so much, and have a lovely day.”*
>
> **ACTION:** *Log: No answer / Voicemail left. Try once more after 2 days at a different time. If still no response after 3 attempts, mark as Unreachable and move on.*

07 — OBJECTION HANDLING

Common questions & how to answer

These come up. Have crisp answers ready — don't fumble.

IF THEY SAY:	YOU RESPOND:
"I haven't seen the email — could you resend it?"	"Absolutely, sir/ma'am. I'll resend it right after this call. Could you please confirm the best email address to use?"
"I'm out of station that weekend."	"Completely understand, sir/ma'am. Thank you for letting me know. I'll keep you on our list for our next event so you don't miss out. Safe travels!"
"What's the dress code?"	"Smart formals or business casuals would be perfect, sir/ma'am — the inauguration and panel are formal, and the evening soirée is more relaxed."
"Can I bring my spouse / a guest?"	"Yes, sir/ma'am, you're very welcome to bring your spouse, especially for the evening soirée. I'll mark a +1 against your name."
"I'm not from BM 38 — I graduated long ago."	"Sir/ma'am, the invitation is extended to all PGDM-BM alumni regardless of batch. In fact, having senior alumni present is what makes the soirée meaningful for all of us. We'd love to host you back."
"Is there parking on campus?"	"Yes, sir/ma'am, dedicated parking will be arranged. The final reminder email will include parking and entry details closer to the date."
"How long is the panel discussion?"	"The panel runs from 12 to 2 PM, sir/ma'am — about 90 minutes of moderated discussion followed by 30 minutes of open Q&A with the students."
"Do I need to bring or do anything?"	"Not at all, sir/ma'am, just yourself. We'd love to have you participate in the Q&A if you're inclined, but there's absolutely no expectation."
"Can I come only for the evening soirée?"	"Of course, sir/ma'am — many alumni prefer to join us for the evening alone. The soirée starts at 7 PM, and you're warmly welcome whenever you can make it."

IF THEY SAY:	YOU RESPOND:
"What time will it end?"	"The networking soirée wraps up by 10 PM, sir/ma’am. The earlier sessions conclude by 5 PM if you’d prefer to attend only the day programme."

Dos and don’ts

DO

- ✓ Smile while speaking — they can hear it in your voice.
- ✓ Address them as “Sir” or “Ma’am” until they invite first-name use.
- ✓ Speak clearly and at a moderate pace.
- ✓ Pause after the RSVP ask — let them respond.
- ✓ Confirm spelling of their name when you note it.
- ✓ Thank them sincerely whether they say yes or no.
- ✓ Keep the call under 3 minutes unless they want to chat.
- ✓ Note dietary preferences, +1, and accessibility needs if confirmed.

DON’T

- ✗ Don’t sound like a telemarketer — no fake enthusiasm.
- ✗ Don’t pressure or guilt-trip if they decline.
- ✗ Don’t promise things not in the schedule.
- ✗ Don’t speak over them or interrupt.
- ✗ Don’t say “ummm” or “like” repeatedly — pause instead.
- ✗ Don’t call before 10 AM or after 9 PM.
- ✗ Don’t take it personally if they’re brusque or short.
- ✗ Don’t promise to send the email immediately if you can’t.

09 — POST-CALL

What to log after every call

Update the RSVP tracker immediately — don't rely on memory between calls.

FIELD	WHAT TO RECORD
Alum name	*Exact spelling, with salutation if you used one*
Call outcome	*Connected / Voicemail / No answer / Bad time / Wrong number*
RSVP status	*Confirmed / Declined / Pending callback / Unreachable*
Callback date	*If pending — note exact date and time*
+1 count	*0 if alone, 1 if spouse/guest*
Dietary preference	*Veg / Non-veg / Jain / Other (only if confirmed)*
Notes	*Out of town reason, accessibility, friend they want to attend with, etc.*
Volunteer name	*Your name — for accountability if alum calls back*

10 — QUICK REFERENCE

The 90-second call, distilled

If you're nervous before a call, glance at this. The entire script in five steps.

The Sankalan call, in five steps

STEP 01 · OPEN

Identify, ask if it's a good time

"Good evening, am I speaking with Mr./Ms. [Surname]? This is [name] from MDI Gurgaon's Corporate Communications Committee. Have I caught you at a good time?"

STEP 02 · BRIDGE

Reference the email already sent

"You should have received an email from us a few days back regarding Sankalan '26 — our flagship business colloquium. I'm calling as a quick follow-up."

STEP 03 · PITCH

Date · Panel · Day flow · Evening soirée

"Saturday, 20th June at MDI. Panel of CXOs from Reliance, BCG, Flipkart and others on 'Zero-Based Strategy.' Inauguration → Panel 12–2 PM → Lunch → CaseQuest → Networking soirée from 7–10 PM."

STEP 04 · ASK

"May I go ahead and RSVP you?"

"It would be our genuine honour to have you back. May I go ahead and RSVP you as confirmed?" Then stay silent.

STEP 05 · CLOSE

Thank them and log it

Whether yes, no, or maybe — thank them warmly. Update the tracker immediately. Don't rely on memory.